

Basement Flooding Prevention — Action Checklist

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DIAGNOSE THE SOURCE

- ☐ **Determine if water enters through your floor drain specifically during heavy rain to confirm sewer backup rather than surface water intrusion.:** Determine if water enters through your floor drain specifically during heavy rain to confirm sewer backup rather than surface water intrusion.
- ☐ **Check for unusual sewage smell when water appears to verify that contaminated municipal water is backing up into your basement.:** Check for unusual sewage smell when water appears to verify that contaminated municipal water is backing up into your basement.
- ☐ **Answer the diagnostic questions about when water appears and under what conditions to correctly identify your flooding type.:** Answer the diagnostic questions about when water appears and under what conditions to correctly identify your flooding type.
- ☐ **Time how quickly water fills a container placed over the floor drain during the next heavy rain to understand peak flow volume.:** Time how quickly water fills a container placed over the floor drain during the next heavy rain to understand peak flow volume.

INSTALL BACKWATER VALVE

- ☐ **Choose a check valve (automatic spring-loaded) over a gate valve (manual) for sewer backup protection so the valve operates without requiring human action before storms.:** Choose a check valve (automatic spring-loaded) over a gate valve (manual) for sewer backup protection so the valve operates without requiring human action before storms.
 - ☐ **Have a licensed plumber assess whether interior installation through a cleanout access point is possible at your home to avoid costly exterior excavation.:** Have a licensed plumber assess whether interior installation through a cleanout access point is possible at your home to avoid costly exterior excavation.
 - ☐ **Budget \$300-\$800 for backwater valve materials and professional installation while checking for municipal subsidies that may cover up to \$1,250.:** Budget \$300-\$800 for backwater valve materials and professional installation while checking for municipal subsidies that may cover up to \$1,250.
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- ☐ **Obtain required permits from your local jurisdiction before installation since most municipalities mandate permits for backwater valve work.:** Obtain required permits from your local jurisdiction before installation since most municipalities mandate permits for backwater valve work.

LAYER YOUR DEFENSES

- ☐ **Install a sump pump as a secondary defense mechanism to remove water that accumulates from groundwater seepage or any water that bypasses your primary protection.:** Install a sump pump as a secondary defense mechanism to remove water that accumulates from groundwater seepage or any water that bypasses your primary protection.
- ☐ **Keep the floor drain area unobstructed and accessible so you can place a temporary container if needed during unexpected backup events.:** Keep the floor drain area unobstructed and accessible so you can place a temporary container if needed during unexpected backup events.
- ☐ **Test your backwater valve annually or after any plumbing work to verify the flapper or gate moves freely and seals properly.:** Test your backwater valve annually or after any plumbing work to verify the flapper or gate moves freely and seals properly.
- ☐ **Inspect the valve during or immediately after heavy rain when possible to confirm it has closed and protected your basement.:** Inspect the valve during or immediately after heavy rain when possible to confirm it has closed and protected your basement.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.